

A04 Contribution Journal

Wizards vs Aliens: How Neural Networks Make Decisions

Team: DataProxy

Course: ITAI 2376

Team Members: Jonah Joseph, Fifehanmi O., Justin Davis, Brandon Matias, Samantha Mireles, and Elijah Raines

Project Contribution Overview

Our group created a simple wizard-versus-alien game to explain how a neural network uses weights, bias, and an activation function to make a decision. We divided the presentation into connected parts so each member could teach one step of the process. The lesson starts with the battle story and its clues, turns importance into easy-to-count stars, adds a bonus star for bias, and applies a final rule that tells the wizard to attack or wait. We also included an interactive game and real-world AI examples so the audience could connect the classroom model to familiar technology.

Team Roles and Contributions

Team Member	Primary Role	Contribution to A04
Jonah Joseph	Story and objective	Introduced the wizard hero, the alien boss, and the main question: should the wizard attack or wait? His opening gave the audience a clear goal and prepared them to follow each decision step.
Fifehanmi O.	Battle setup and clues	Helped explain the alien encounter and the information the AI checks before choosing. This section focused on health, armor, and boss distance as clues that describe the wizard's situation.
Justin Davis	Weights and star system	Explained that stars represent weights, or how much attention the AI gives each clue. Health receives two stars and armor receives one, showing that some information matters more than other information.
Brandon Matias	Bias and bonus star	Explained bias as one extra bonus star that gives the decision an added push. His example showed how two starting stars plus one bias star can reach the three-star attack level.
Samantha Mireles	Activation and final choice	Explained the activation function as the final rule. Three or more stars means attack, while two or fewer means wait, turning the earlier clues, weights, and bias into one clear decision.
Elijah Raines	Interactive game and demonstration	Organized the hands-on game so the audience could pick a clue, count the stars, and choose attack or wait. The clickable game helped show the decision process instead of only describing it.

How the Contributions Worked Together

The presentation follows the same order as the wizard's decision. Jonah introduces the battle and the attack-or-wait objective. Fifehanmi identifies the clues that the AI must examine. Justin then shows how weights give those clues different levels of importance, and Brandon explains how bias adds an extra push. Samantha finishes the calculation with the activation rule, while Elijah lets the audience practice the whole sequence through the interactive game.

Our group also worked together on the real-world examples and final reflection. We compared the wizard's choice with car AI that looks at the road, voice AI that listens to words, and game AI that watches the player. These examples helped us show that real systems use more information and more complicated calculations, but they still follow the same basic pattern of examining inputs, deciding what matters, adjusting the result, and making a choice.

Teamwork Takeaways

Dividing the lesson into small parts made the technical ideas easier to explain. Each member had a specific responsibility, but no section stood alone. The clues gave the weights something to measure, the weights and bias created the score, and the activation function turned that score into an action. The interactive game then brought all of those parts together in a way the audience could test for themselves.

We also learned that a strong group presentation needs consistent examples and simple language. Using the same stars, bonus star, and attack-or-wait rule throughout the slides kept the lesson clear. Because everyone connected their role to the same wizard battle, the final presentation felt like one complete explanation instead of several separate reports.

Contribution Summary

Every team member contributed an important part of A04. Jonah established the story and objective, Fifehanmi explained the battle clues, Justin covered weights, Brandon covered bias, Samantha explained activation, and Elijah organized the interactive demonstration. As a group, we connected the game to real-world AI and reflected on how the parts work together. The result was a student-friendly lesson that explained how information can lead to a final decision.